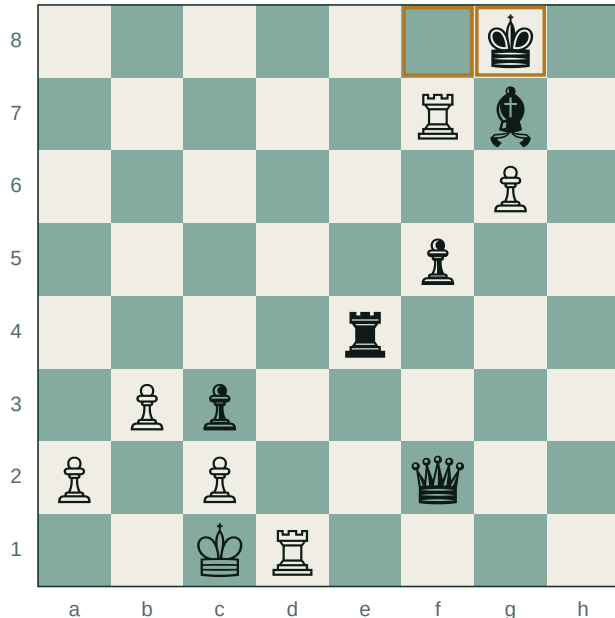


Exposed-king tactics: White, move 42

Exposed-king tactics

White to move



Previous move: 41...Kg8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

42. Rd8+ Re8 43. Rxe8+ Bf8 44. Rxf8#

42.Rd8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **42...Re8**.

43.Rxe8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on e8. Recorded reply: **43...Bf8**.

44.Rxf8# Mate: rook on f8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on f8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: queen on f2. Check for tactical protection.